The Course of the Great War (1914–1918)

KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 30 HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS

Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____



British Vickers machine gun crew in the frontline near Ovillers during the Battle of the Somme (July 1916) • Industrialized rapid-fire weapons locked armies in defensive trench warfare.

LESSON ENQUIRY FOCUS	HW DUE DATE	1. SOLO (WRITTEN)	2. PARTNER (VERBAL)	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
Enquiry 1: Recruitment & Propaganda Lord Kitchener's recruitment call, Pals Battalions, patriotic propaganda, 'Over by Christmas' myth & 1914 BEF	_____	___ / 6	___ / 6	_____
Enquiry 2: Trench Warfare & The Somme Trench system stalemate, artillery bombardments, Sir Douglas Haig, 1916 Battle of the Somme & combined arms	_____	___ / 6	___ / 6	_____
Enquiry 3: Empire Troops & Global Reach 1.3 million Indian Army troops, 1915 Gallipoli landings (ANZAC), British West Indies Regiment & global supply lines	_____	___ / 6	___ / 6	_____
Enquiry 4: Home Front & Women at War 1914 Defence of the Realm Act (DORA), Munitionettes ('Canary Girls'), food queues, 1916 conscription & 1918 vote	_____	___ / 6	___ / 6	_____
Enquiry 5: 1918 Armistice & Remembrance 1918 German Spring Offensive, Allied Hundred Days Offensive, Kiel Mutiny, 11 November 1918 Armistice & Remembrance	_____	___ / 6	___ / 6	_____

HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:

1. SOLO (WRITTEN): Complete your 6 write-in lines from memory without looking. Check your answers in green pen using the Department Marking Bank on Pages 7–8.

2. PARTNER (VERBAL): Hand your booklet to a **PARENT, CARER, FAMILY MEMBER, OR STUDY BUDDY** to test you out loud from the Marking Bank until you hit 6/6!

Scan for Interactive Digital Quizzes & Audio Lessons:
Access online self-marking retrieval flashcards, diagnostic feedback, and audio narration at the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app.

1. ► **Who appeared on famous recruitment posters pointing his finger with the slogan "Your Country Needs You"?** [Lord Kitchener / Winston Churchill]

Core Fact: _____

This meant that... _____

2. ► **What was the nickname given to battalions of friends, workmates, and neighbours who enlisted together in 1914?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

3. ►► **Why did hundreds of thousands of young British men rush to enlist in August and September 1914?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

4. ►► **What symbol of cowardice was publicly handed to young men in civilian clothes on British streets?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

5. ►►► **Why did the concept of "Pals Battalions" ultimately prove to be a catastrophic social tragedy?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

6. ►►► **How did the transition from a small professional army to a mass citizen army transform British society?**

Core Fact: _____

As a result... _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Lord Kitchener | Pals Battalions | White Feather | Propaganda | Over by Christmas | BEF (120,000)

7. ► **Which weapon was responsible for approximately 60% of all combat casualties on the Western Front?** [Heavy Artillery / Poison Gas]

Core Fact: _____

This was because... _____

8. ► **What painful medical condition was caused by soldiers standing in cold, waterlogged mud for days?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

9. ►► **Why were frontline trenches constructed in a zig-zag or traverse pattern rather than straight lines?**

Core Fact: _____

To prevent... _____

10. ►► **Why did the week-long British artillery bombardment fail to destroy German defenses before the Somme in 1916?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

11. ►►► **Why is Field Marshal Sir Douglas Haig remembered both as the "Butcher of the Somme" and the architect of victory?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

12. ►►► **How did the development of tanks and creeping barrages eventually break the trench deadlock in 1918?**

Core Fact: _____

Consequently... _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | No Man's Land | Trench Foot | Heavy Artillery | Sir Douglas Haig | The Somme (1916) | Combined Arms |

13. ► **Approximately how many Indian soldiers and labourers served the British Empire during the Great War?** [Over 1.3 million / 50,000]

Core Fact: _____

This meant that... _____

14. ► **What acronym was given to the Australian and New Zealand Army Corps who landed at Gallipoli in 1915?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

15. ►► **What strategic objective did Winston Churchill hope to achieve by attacking the Ottoman Empire at Gallipoli in 1915?**

Core Fact: _____

To... _____

16. ►► **Why were soldiers of the British West Indies Regiment often denied front-line combat roles?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

17. ►►► **Why was the global contribution of colonial and African troops largely erased from popular British memory after 1918?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

18. ►►► **How did participation in the Great War accelerate demands for national independence across the British Empire?**

Core Fact: _____

As a result... _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Indian Army (1.3M) | ANZAC | Gallipoli (1915) | British West Indies Regt | Labour Corps | East Africa Campaign

19. ► **What landmark law passed in August 1914 gave the British government sweeping emergency powers over daily life?**

[DORA (Defence of the Realm Act) / The Factory Act]

Core Fact: _____

This meant that... _____

20. ► **What nickname was given to female munitions workers whose skin turned yellow from handling toxic TNT chemicals?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

21. ►► **Why was compulsory conscription introduced for unmarried British men aged 18 to 41 in January 1916?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

22. ►► **Why did the British government introduce compulsory food rationing for sugar, butter, and meat in early 1918?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

23. ►►► **How did women's wartime work permanently shatter traditional Victorian gender stereotypes?**

Core Fact: _____

By proving that... _____

24. ►►► **To what extent did women's war work directly lead to women gaining the parliamentary vote in 1918?**

Core Fact: _____

Consequently... _____

KEY TERM VAULT: DORA (1914) | Munitionettes | Canary Girls | Rationing (1918) | Conscription (1916) | 1918 Representation Act

25. ► **On what date and at what exact time did the First World War armistice officially come into effect?**

[11 November 1918 at 11:00 am / 28 June 1919 at midnight]

Core Fact: _____

This meant that... _____

26. ► **What mutiny by German sailors in late October 1918 sparked a revolution that forced Kaiser Wilhelm II to abdicate?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

27. ►► **Why did Germany's massive Spring Offensive (Kaiserschlacht) fail despite initial breakthroughs in March 1918?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

28. ►► **What malicious myth claimed that the German army was not defeated in the field but betrayed by socialists at home?**

Core Fact: _____

Known as... _____

29. ►►► **Why was the burial of the "Unknown Warrior" in Westminster Abbey in 1920 so emotionally powerful for grieving families?**

Core Fact: _____

Because... _____

30. ►►► **How did the human cost of the Great War shape European attitudes toward future conflict in the 1920s and 1930s?**

Core Fact: _____

Consequently... _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Spring Offensive | Kiel Mutiny | Hundred Days | 11 November 1918 | Stab in the Back | Cenotaph & Unknown Warrior

ENQUIRY 1: RECRUITMENT & PROPAGANDA

1. ► **Lord Horatio Kitchener (Secretary of State for War)** — *Kitchener predicted a long, grueling war requiring an army of millions, launching mass recruitment campaigns.* [✓] [✗]

2. ► **Pals Battalions** — *Units like the Accrington Pals and Grimsby Chums allowed men from the same town or factory to serve side-by-side.* [✓] [✗]

3. ►► **A wave of patriotic enthusiasm, peer pressure, and the popular belief the war would be over by Christmas** — *Young men viewed enlistment as an exciting adventure, an escape from mundane factory work, and a moral duty.* [✓] [✗]

4. ►► **A white feather** — *The White Feather movement used public humiliation to shame men who had not enlisted into joining the army.* [✓] [✗]

5. ►►► **Catastrophic casualties at the Somme wiped out an entire generation from specific towns on a single day** — *When battalions were shattered on 1 July 1916, single communities lost hundreds of young men simultaneously, devastating northern towns.* [✓] [✗]

6. ►►► **It made the war an inescapable national trauma touching every household and community across Britain** — *The scale of bereavement transformed political expectations, sparking demands for universal voting rights and social welfare reform.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 2: TRENCH WARFARE & THE SOMME

7. ► **Heavy Artillery (high-explosive shells and shrapnel)** — *Relentless artillery barrages pulverized trenches, caused catastrophic physical trauma, and induced severe shell shock.* [✓] [✗]

8. ► **Trench Foot** — *Prolonged exposure to damp mud caused fungal infection, numbness, and gangrene, often requiring amputation.* [✓] [✗]

9. ►► **Enemy machine-gunners from firing along the whole trench and to contain artillery blast shockwaves** — *The angular layout prevented enfilade fire and ensured that an artillery shell detonating in a trench contained its blast to a single bay.* [✓] [✗]

10. ►► **A third of the shells were duds and deep German concrete bunkers protected troops underground** — *When the bombardment lifted, German machine-gunners emerged from deep dugouts to mow down British infantry crossing No Man's Land.* [✓] [✗]

11. ►►► **Critics condemn his costly attrition tactics, while defenders argue he adapted modern technology to win in 1918** — *Haig presided over 57,000 casualties on 1 July 1916, but later mastered combined-arms warfare in the decisive 1918 Hundred Days Offensive.* [✓] [✗]

12. ►►► **Combined-arms coordination crushed barbed wire and suppressed machine guns, restoring mobility** — *Allied coordination of artillery, tanks, infantry, and aircraft replaced suicidal frontal charges with rapid mobile breakthroughs.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 3: EMPIRE TROOPS & GLOBAL REACH

13. ► **Over 1.3 million Indian soldiers and personnel** — *Indian regiments fought in the freezing mud of Ypres, in Mesopotamia (Iraq), and across the deserts of Palestine.* [✓] [✗]

14. ► **The ANZACs** — *The catastrophic Gallipoli campaign against the Ottoman Empire became a defining foundation of Australian and New Zealand national identity.* [✓] [✗]

15. ►► **Knock the Ottoman Empire out of the war and open a Black Sea supply route to Russia** — *Churchill sought an indirect maritime route to relieve pressure on the Western Front, but Ottoman forces pinned the Allies to the beaches.* [✓] [✗]

16. ►► **Racial prejudice from British authorities restricted Black colonial troops to heavy labouring and ammunition loading** — *Despite volunteering eagerly, colonial authorities feared training Black soldiers in combat arms would threaten postwar imperial rule.* [✓] [✗]

17. ►►► **Postwar imperial propaganda centered national remembrance exclusively on white European soldiers on the Western Front** — *War memorials and histories celebrated British sacrifices in Flanders, sidelining the hundreds of thousands of African, Indian, and Caribbean troops.* [✓] [✗]

18. ►►► **Colonial troops who fought for "freedom in Europe" returned home demanding equal political self-determination** — *Sacrifices made by Indian and African soldiers undermined European claims of racial superiority and catalyzed early anti-colonial movements.* [✓] [✗]

Department Marking Bank • Part 2

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 4 to 5 (Questions 19 to 30)

ENQUIRIES 4–5

ENQUIRY 4: HOME FRONT & WOMEN AT WAR

19. ► **DORA (Defence of the Realm Act)** — *DORA permitted the government to censor newspapers, take over factories, nationalize railways, and dilute beer.* [✓] [✗]

20. ► **"Canary Girls"** — *Toxic exposure to sulphuric acid and TNT stained skin yellow, damaged lungs, and caused early miscarriages in munitions plants.* [✓] [✗]

21. ►► **Voluntary enlistment collapsed while devastating casualties on the Western Front created an acute manpower shortage** — *The bloody slaughter at Neuve Chapelle and Loos exhausted the volunteer army, forcing Prime Minister Asquith to pass the Military Service Act.* [✓] [✗]

22. ►► **German Unrestricted Submarine Warfare sank merchant ships, causing severe civilian food shortages and panic buying** — *U-boats sank hundreds of cargo vessels in the Atlantic, threatening Britain with starvation until rationing ensured equitable food sharing.* [✓] [✗]

23. ►►► **Women could capably perform heavy industrial labor, operate machinery, and sustain the war economy** — *Nearly a million women worked in munitions, transport, and agriculture, disproving Victorian arguments that women were physically and mentally frail.* [✓] [✗]

24. ►►► **It created an undeniable moral debt, though the 1918 Act granted votes only to women over 30 with property** — *Politicians could not deny the vote to women who saved the nation, but established older age thresholds to avoid a female voting majority.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 5: 1918 ARMISTICE & REMEMBRANCE

25. ► **11 November 1918 at 11:00 am (the eleventh hour of the eleventh day of the eleventh month)** — *The armistice was signed in a railway carriage in the Compiègne forest, silencing the guns after four years of slaughter.* [✓] [✗]

26. ► **The Kiel Mutiny** — *Sailors refused to launch a suicidal final naval attack against the Royal Navy, triggering worker-soldier revolts across Germany.* [✓] [✗]

27. ►► **Stormtroopers outran their supply lines, exhausted their troops, and faced fresh American reinforcements** — *Germany suffered 240,000 casualties and captured empty cratered ground while the arrival of fresh US troops tilted the balance permanently.* [✓] [✗]

28. ►► **The "Stab-in-the-Back" myth (Dolchstoßlegende)** — *Defeated generals like Ludendorff falsely blamed politicians, socialists, and Jews, later exploited by Adolf Hitler to destroy democracy.* [✓] [✗]

29. ►►► **It provided a universal tomb for hundreds of thousands whose sons had no known grave and whose bodies were never found** — *With over 500,000 British soldiers having no identified resting place, any grieving mother could believe the Unknown Warrior was her own son.* [✓] [✗]

30. ►►► **It created an overwhelming desire for peace and appeasement, vowing that such industrial slaughter must "Never Again" happen** — *The catastrophic loss of 20 million lives produced profound anti-war sentiment across Britain and France, directly informing the policy of appeasing Hitler.* [✓] [✗]

UNIT CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS • 4 CORE ANCHORS

ATTRITION: A military strategy of wearing down the enemy to the point of physical collapse through continuous losses of personnel and material (e.g. Verdun, The Somme).

TOTAL WAR: A war that involves the complete mobilization of entire populations, industrial economies, and resources, erasing boundaries between soldiers and civilians.

CONSCRIPTION: Compulsory enlistment of civilians into the armed forces, introduced in Britain by the Military Service Acts in 1916 after voluntary recruitment dwindled.

ARMISTICE: An agreement made by opposing sides in a war to stop fighting for a certain time; the ceasefire signed in Compiègne on 11 November 1918 ended hostilities.